

003 Make a bumblebee nest box

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MINS

Bumblebees nest in the ground. The queen bumblebee usually tries to find an abandoned mouse or vole hole by tracking the scent of the rodent's nest, but you can help out the bees by building this bumblebee nest box.

What you need

- Trowel • 4 stones
- Flowerpot
- 5 x 5 in (12 x 12 cm) piece of slate • Hay or wood shavings



1 Dig a hole in the ground deep enough to hold the flowerpot. The pot needs to be ceramic, with a central drainage hole.



2 Add hay or wood shavings. This will help the queen to find it because it will smell like a mouse's nest.

Cover keeps out rain



3 Put the upturned flowerpot in the hole, set out the stones in a square shape around it, and place the slate on top to keep out the rain.



004 Plant a bee-friendly garden

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Fill your garden with flowering bee-friendly plants such as lavender, *Lavender* buddleias, anemones—anything with nectar-rich flowers. Species that bloom at different times will give bees a constant food source.

